

# KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 11

## --"MINI-MEETNG" FORMAT-- (20 min)

### I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

### II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

### III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

## BIBLE TEACHING

Let's dig a little deeper into KF Confession 3:

We constructed legal systems based on our own assessment of good and evil.

We are now going back to the letter from James for a little while. Take a look at chapter one again. We learned that having our faith, or trust, tested is essential for our growth. If we want to grow, we will welcome life's events because they show us where we have put our trust—whether in God or in our Idol Self. In our training, we apply the Apostle John's idea of the *day of judgment* to our everyday life events. These events take us into a courtroom of examination where the truth about our souls is revealed. James uses different imagery and calls these events *experiments*, as in a laboratory. These experiments reveal the nature and quality of our trust.

God brings into our lives people and situations that stir up areas that need examination and healing. One of these areas is the area of wealth. We can be rich in money, skill, time, health, relationships, antecedents, and natural gifts. We can also be poor in any of those areas. Our tendency is to judge wealth or poverty as good or evil.

This is Nancy's paraphrase of **James 1:9–12**.

<sup>9</sup>To the siblings of small resources, rather than feeling shame, let them proclaim their trust from their high place of living within limitations. <sup>10</sup>The wealthy can proclaim their trust by living as a lowly creature within limitations, rather than using their wealth to avoid limitations, because the reality is that, like a flower of the grassland, the wealthy will pass away. <sup>11</sup>For we know that the sun rises with the burning heat, and then the grass dries up; its flower falls, and its attractive façade is utterly destroyed. Even so, while going along in his or her way, the person of large resources will also fade away, just like all creatures. <sup>12</sup>Happy is the one who endures life's experiments, whatever that person's circumstances may be, so that, being approved as genuine and trustworthy, that one will receive the crown of life which God has promised to those who are loving Him.

Take a deep breath.

We often judge wealth as good because we perceive wealth as the absence of limitations. What bliss for the Idol Self to be free from limitations! Our Idol then develops an attachment to wealth as a desirable and even a necessary thing.

Poverty might be defined as an extremely limited lifestyle. That makes poverty particularly evil for the Idol. The limitations imposed by poverty or loss of wealth does not allow our Idol to be superior or free. However, when we judge wealth or poverty as good or evil, we are not seeing things from God's perspective. God has already told us that this world is passing away.

Perhaps we find ourselves stuck in poverty in some area of our lives. We may need to feel poor in order to justify the demands that we make on ourselves and on others. In our minds, poverty entitles us to what others have and relieves us of responsibilities; we can always use it as an excuse for our underdevelopment. We might even enjoy a sense of superiority because in our poverty we see ourselves as the underdog—unselfish and non-materialistic.

When our identity is wrapped up in wealth or poverty rather than in the love of God, we believe that we deserve accommodation from others and from life. This makes us vulnerable to disappointment. If we are not accommodated, we feel a sense of loss and this hurts our pride. Attaching to accommodation creates anxiety. We live with the fear that our hope for some kind of wealth or superiority will not materialize and that without those resources we will not be able to support our Idol's search for glory. We have attached our happiness to outcomes that we imagine will save our pride and deliver us from the fear of loss. When those outcomes elude us, we feel disappointed.

James warns us that when we attach to something that, like the grass, is passing away, we set ourselves up for all kinds of disappointments. Fear of loss stagnates our lives and numbs our creativity, driving us into all kinds of misorientation and resulting in more disappointment and loss. We live in a world that is passing away, but we are depending on it for our joy. How crazy is that? As eternal creatures, we just weren't designed to attach to this material world. James teaches us quite a bit about wealth in his letter. He is not against wealth, but he is against how we use wealth to support the Idol Self. Humble circumstances, or poverty in some area, can be glorious because people with fewer resources are invited to develop more trust in God. They learn to be grateful for everything. They learn to live within limitations and are highly motivated to change their lives. Their hunger is stronger than their fear.

The wealthy—and again we mean those who are rich in money, abilities, possessions, family background, or experiences—are to glory in humiliation by actively participating in the limitations experienced by the rest of the world. They can acknowledge their position as fellow creatures by demonstrating trustworthiness and active kindness. They must circulate gifts *in proportion to their resources*, or their souls will stagnate into fear and self-hate.

In poverty or wealth, persevering in the development of the True Self is the key to success. Through perseverance we gain practical experience both in the world and in our relationship with God. This practical experience grows our self-confidence and gives us greater authority in whatever socio-economic mission field we are designed to serve. Who gives us the stamp of approval when we persevere in the development of the True Self? Certainly God, but we too can approve the outcomes of an oriented life.

I hope that you will experience both poverty and wealth in many areas of your life, and at different times. Poverty can cleanse and prune the soul, while wealth can support more opportunities for exploration and service. Your goal is to be complete and lack nothing. By running your race with endurance, whether in poverty or in wealth, you learn to wear your crown of life, in this life, with authority and love.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Father, teach me to glory in both poverty and in wealth. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

## **ENDING PRAYER**

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You continue to guide us to our real glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and design. Help us to circulate with our community, with the rest of the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.